Sutter Health

Billing and Collections Policy for Sutter Hospitals Policy

EFFECTIVE DATE

The effective date of this Billing and Collections Policy for Sutter Hospitals is January 1, 2025.

PURPOSE

The purpose of this policy is to establish procedures for hospital billing and collection processes.

POLICY

It is our policy to bill patients and applicable Third-Party Payers accurately, timely, and consistently with applicable laws and regulations, including without limitation California Health and Safety Code section 127400 et seq., 22 California Code of Regulations section 96051 et seq., and regulations issued by the United States Department of the Treasury under section 501(r) of the Internal Revenue Code.

SCOPE

This policy applies to Sutter Health and any legal entity for which Sutter Health or its affiliate is the sole member or directly or indirectly controls greater than 50% of the voting power or equity interest and does not have a third-party manager (herein referred to as Sutter). This policy applies to any billing or Collection Agency working on behalf of a hospital.

DEFINITIONS

Billed Charges means the undiscounted amounts that a hospital customarily bills for items and services.

Collection Agency means any entity engaged by a hospital to pursue or collect payment from Patients.

Extraordinary Collection Action means any of the following:

- Any action to obtain payment from a Patient that requires a legal or judicial process, including without limitation, the filing of a lawsuit;
- Selling a Patient's debt to the hospital to another party, including without limitation, to a Collection Agency;

- Reporting adverse information about a Patient to a consumer credit reporting agency or credit bureau;
- Seizing a bank account;
- Causing an arrest in connection with collection of a debt;
- Wage garnishment;
- Lien on a residence or any other personal or real property;
- Foreclosure on real or personal property;
- Delay or denial of medically necessary care based on the existence of an outstanding balance for prior service(s); or
- Obtaining an order for examination.

Extraordinary Collection Actions do not include the assertion of, or collection under, a lien asserted under Civil Code sections 3040 or 3045. Further, filing a claim in a bankruptcy proceeding is not an Extraordinary Collection Action.

Federal Health Care Program means any plan or program providing health care benefits, whether directly through insurance or otherwise, that is funded directly, in whole or in part by the U.S. government. Federal Health Care Programs include, but are not limited to, traditional fee-for-service Medicare and Medi-Cal, Medicare Advantage plans, TRICARE, Veterans' Administration and Indian Health Service programs.

Financial Assistance refers to Full Charity Care and High Medical Cost Charity Care, as those terms are defined in the Sutter Policy on Financial Assistance for Sutter Hospitals (Charity Care).

Guarantor means a person who has legal financial responsibility for the Patient's health care services.

Insured Patient means a Patient who has a third-party source of payment for a portion of their medical expenses.

Patient means an individual who received medical services at a Sutter hospital. All references to a Patient in this Policy shall be deemed to include the Guarantor.

Patient Responsibility means the amount that an Insured Patient is responsible to pay out-of-pocket after the Patient's Third-Party Payer has determined the amount of the Patient's benefits.

Payer is a commercial or government sponsored third party that is financially responsible to pay for some portion of a Patient's medical care services.

Self-Pay Patient means a Patient who has benefits for items/services under a group health plan, group or individual health insurance coverage offered by a health insurance issuer, or a health benefits plan, but does not seek to have a claim submitted to their plan, issuer, or carrier for the item or service.

Third-Party Payer means a non-government third-party payer that provides coverage for health care services to a Patient.

Uninsured Patient means a Patient who has no third-party source of payment for any portion of their medical expenses, including without limitation, commercial or other insurance, government sponsored health care benefit programs, or third-party liability, and includes a Patient whose benefits under all potential sources of payment have been exhausted prior to an admission.

PROCEDURES

A. Billing Third-Party Payers

1. **Obtaining Coverage Information**. Hospitals shall make reasonable efforts to obtain information from Patients about whether private or public health insurance may fully or partially cover the services rendered by the hospital to the Patient. However, Hospitals shall not require a patient to apply for any private or public health insurance or sponsorship, including any Federal Health Care Program or State payer, to be screened for or provided Financial Assistance.

2. **Billing Third-Party Payers**. Hospitals shall diligently pursue all amounts due from Third-Party Payers, including but not limited to, contracted and non-contracted Payers, other insurance companies, liability and auto insurers, and government program Payers that may be financially responsible for a Patient's care. Sutter will bill all applicable Third-Party Payers based on information provided by or verified by the Patient or their representative in a timely manner.

3. **Dispute Resolution with Third Party Payers**. Before initiating litigation or arbitration against a Third-Party Payer, hospitals should consult and comply with the Policy on Initiating Litigation or Arbitration Involving Third Party Payers.

B. Billing Patients. Each hospital's individual responsible for finance, or designee, shall grant to Sutter Shared Services (S3) the authority to pursue collections from Patients.

1. **Billing Insured Patients**. Hospitals shall promptly bill Insured Patients for the Patient Responsibility amount as computed by the explanation of benefits and directed by the Third-Party Payer.

2. **Billing Uninsured Patients**. When an Uninsured Patient has not been approved to receive Financial Assistance, hospitals shall promptly bill Uninsured Patients for items and services provided by the hospital, using hospital's Billed Charges less the standard uninsured discount or rural uninsured discount, as follows:

    a. *Standard Uninsured Discount* is a 40% reduction of Billed Charges for inpatient services and 20% reduction of Billed Charges for outpatient services.

    b. *Rural Uninsured Discount* is a 20% reduction of Billed Charges for inpatient and outpatient Services at rural hospitals (e.g., Sutter Lakeside Hospital and Center for Health, Sutter Coast Hospital, and Sutter Amador Hospital).

    c. The Uninsured Patient discount does not apply to patients who qualify for Financial Assistance or receive services that are already discounted (i.e., package discounts for cosmetic services). Case rate and package rate pricing should not result in an expected payment that is less than what the hospital would expect had the Uninsured Patient discount been applied to Billed Charges for the services.

3. **Financial Assistance Information**. All bills to Patients shall include the Notice of Rights (see **Attachment B)**, which includes a summary of Financial Assistance that is available to eligible Patients.

4. **Itemized Statement**. All Patients may request an itemized statement for their account at any time.

5. **Disputes**. Any Patient may dispute an item or charge on their bill. Patients may initiate a dispute in writing or over the phone with a customer service representative. If a Patient requests documentation regarding the bill, staff members will use reasonable efforts to provide the requested documentation within ten (10) calendar days. Hospitals will hold the account for at least thirty (30) calendar days after the Patient initiates the dispute before engaging in further collection activities.

C. Good Faith Estimates (GFE)

1. **Notice of Right to Request GFE**. Uninsured and Self-Pay Patients must be advised both orally and in writing that they have the right to request a

GFE before they schedule an item or service, and if not requested, a GFE of expected charges must be provided upon scheduling.

2. **Content of GFE**. The GFE must reflect the expected charges, including any expected discounts or other relevant adjustments that the provider or facility expects to apply to an Uninsured or Self-Pay Patient's actual Billed Charges.

3. **Delivery of GFE**. Pursuant to the Uninsured or Self-Pay Patient's requested method of delivery, the GFE must be provided either on paper or electronically (for example, electronic transmission of the GFE through provider's patient portal or electronic mail). If provided electronically, it must be provided in a manner that allows the GFE to be saved and printed.

4. **Timing of Delivery of GFE**

    a. If an Uninsured or Self-Pay Patient requests the GFE prior to scheduling a service, the GFE must be provided no later than three (3) business days after the request.

    b. If a service is scheduled at least three (3) days, but less than ten (10) days in advance, the GFE must be provided no later than one (1) business day after the date of scheduling.

    c. If a service is scheduled at least ten (10) days in advance, the GFE must be provided no later than three (3) business days after the date of scheduling.

D. Uninsured/Self-Pay Dispute Resolution Process

1. An Uninsured or Self-Pay Patient has the right to initiate the patient-provider dispute resolution process if the actual Billed Charges are at least $400 more than the total amount of expected charges listed in the GFE.

2. Within one hundred twenty (120) calendar days of receiving the initial bill containing charges at least $400 more than the GFE, an Uninsured or Self-Pay Patient may initiate the patient-provider dispute resolution process by submitting a notification on the Federal Independent Dispute Resolution portal (https://www.cms.gov/medical-bill-rights/help/dispute-a-bill) or on paper to the Secretary of HHS.

E. Collection Practices

1. **General Collection Practices**. Hospitals may employ reasonable collection efforts to obtain payment from Patients. General collection

activities may include issuing Patient statements and making phone calls. Hospitals must develop procedures to confirm that Patient questions and complaints about bills are researched and corrected where appropriate, with timely follow up with the Patient.

2. **Prohibition on Extraordinary Collection Action**. Hospitals and Collection Agencies shall not employ an Extraordinary Collection Action to attempt to collect from a Patient.

3. **No Collection during Financial Assistance Application Process**. Hospital and Collection Agencies shall not pursue collection from a Patient who has submitted an application for Financial Assistance and shall return any amount received from the Patient before or during the time the Patient's application is pending.

4. **No Collection during Uninsured/Self-Pay Dispute Resolution Process**. Hospital may not move a bill into collection, or threaten to do so, if an Uninsured or Self-Pay Patient has initiated the CMS-sponsored patient-provider dispute resolution process, which allows an Uninsured or Self-Pay Patient to challenge a bill when the total Billed Charge is at least $400 more than the total amount of expected charges listed in the GFE. If a bill was previously moved into collection, and the Uninsured or Self-Pay Patient initiates the CMS-sponsored patient-provider dispute resolution process, Hospital and any Collection Agency must cease collection efforts until the conclusion of the dispute resolution process.

5. **Prohibition on Use of Information from Financial Assistance Application**. Hospitals and Collection Agencies may not use in collection activities any information obtained from a Patient during the application process for Financial Assistance. Nothing in this section prohibits the use of information obtained by hospital or Collection Agency independently of the eligibility process for Financial Assistance.

6. **Copayment Waivers**

    a. **Federal and State Health Care Program**. A federal or state health care program Patient's co-pay, coinsurance or deductible amounts may be discounted or waived only if all three (3) of the following requirements are met:

        i. The waiver / discount was not advertised or otherwise solicited;

        ii. The waiver / discount is not routinely offered; and,

        iii. The waiver / discount is made after determining, in good faith, that the individual is in financial need.

b. Facilities shall evaluate each Patient's financial need based on the guidelines found in the applicable Sutter policies on financial assistance and charity care (see Medical Foundation Charity Care and Low Income Uninsured Policy and the Policy on Financial Assistance for Sutter Hospitals (Charity Care)). Any waiver or reduction of a federal or state health care program beneficiary's co-pay, coinsurance or deductible obligation that does not comply with the above standards is prohibited.

7. **Payment Plans:**

a. **Eligible Patients**. Hospitals and any Collection Agency acting on their behalf shall offer Uninsured Patients and any Patient who qualifies for Financial Assistance the option to enter into an agreement to pay their Patient Responsibility (for Insured Patients) and any other amounts due over time. Hospitals may also enter payment plans for Insured Patients who indicate an inability to pay a Patient Responsibility amount in a single installment.

b. **Terms of Payment Plans**. All payment plans shall be interest-free. Patients shall have the opportunity to negotiate the terms of the payment plan, taking into consideration the Patient's family income and essential living expenses. If a hospital and Patient are unable to agree on the terms of the payment plan, the hospital shall extend a payment plan option under which the Patient may make a monthly payment of not more than ten percent (10%) of the Patient's monthly family income after excluding essential living expenses. "Essential living expenses" means expenses for any of the following: rent or house payment and maintenance, food and household supplies, utilities and telephone, clothing, medical and dental payments, insurance, school or child care, child or spousal support, transportation and auto expenses, including insurance, gas, and repairs, installment payments, laundry and cleaning, and other extraordinary expenses.

F. Declaring Payment Plan Inoperative. An extended payment plan may be declared no longer operative after the Patient's failure to make all consecutive payments due during a ninety (90) calendar day period, starting with the first day that the Patient misses a payment. Before declaring the extended payment plan no longer operative, the hospital or Collection Agency shall make a reasonable attempt to contact the Patient by phone and to give notice in writing at least sixty (60) calendar days after the first missed payment that the extended payment plan may become inoperative and that the Patient has the opportunity to renegotiate the extended payment plan. Prior to the extended payment plan being declared inoperative, the hospital or Collection

Agency shall attempt to renegotiate the terms of the defaulted extended payment plan, if requested by the Patient. The Patient shall be given at least thirty (30) calendar days, starting from the date the written notice of the missed payment was sent, to make a payment before the extended payment plan is declared inoperative. For purposes of this section, the notice and phone call to the Patient may be made to the last known phone number and address of the Patient. After a payment plan is declared inoperative, the hospital or Collection Agency may commence collection activities in a manner consistent with this policy. If a payment plan is declared inoperative, and the patient has qualified for Financial Assistance, Hospital or Collection Agency shall limit the amount it seeks from the patient to the amount the patient was responsible to pay after any discounts.

G. Collection Agencies. Hospitals may refer Patient accounts to a Collection Agency, subject to the following conditions:

1. Before sending a Patient account to a Collection Agency, the Hospital shall send a Patient the notice set forth in **Attachment A** (Notice of Assignment to Collection Agency).

2. The Collection Agency must have a written agreement with the hospital.

3. Hospital's written agreement with the Collection Agency must provide that the Collection Agency's performance of its functions shall adhere to Sutter's mission, vision, core values, the terms of the Policy on Financial Assistance for Sutter Hospitals (Charity Care), this policy, the Hospital Fair Pricing Act, Health and Safety Code section 127400 through 127446, and the California Consumer Credit Reporting Agencies Act, .

4. The Collection Agency must agree that it will not engage in any Extraordinary Collection Actions to collect a Patient debt.

5. Hospital must maintain ownership of the debt (i.e., the debt is not "sold" to the Collection Agency).

6. The Collection Agency must have processes in place to identify Patients who may qualify for Financial Assistance, communicate the availability and details of the Policy on Financial Assistance for Sutter Hospitals (Charity Care) to these patients, and refer patients who are seeking Financial Assistance back to the hospital's Patient Financial Services at 855-398-1633 or at sutterhealth.org. The Collection Agency shall not seek any payment from a Patient who has submitted an application for Financial Assistance and shall return any amount received from the Patient before or during the time the Patient's application is pending.

7. All Third-Party Payers must have been properly billed, payment from a Third-Party Payer must no longer be pending, and the remaining debt must be the financial responsibility of the Patient. A Collection Agency shall not bill a Patient for any amount that a Third-Party Payer is obligated to pay.

8. The Collection Agency must send every Patient a copy of the Notice of Rights (see **Attachment B**).

9. At least one hundred-twenty (120) calendar days must have passed since the hospital sent the initial bill to the Patient on the account.

10. The Patient is not negotiating a payment plan or making regular partial payments of a reasonable amount.

H. Third-Party Liability. Nothing in this policy precludes hospital affiliates or outside collection agencies from pursuing third-party liability in a manner consistent with the Hospital Third Party Lien Policy.

1. **Retention of Collection Records**. Hospitals will maintain all records relating to money owed to the Hospital by a Patient or the Patient's guarantor for five (5) years, including, but not limited to, all of the following:

    a. Documents related to litigation filed by the Hospital;

    b. Contracts and significant records by which Hospital assigns or sells medical debt to a third party;

    c. A list, updated at least annually, of every person, including the person's name and contact information, that meets at least one of the following criteria:

        i. The person is a debt collector to whom the Hospital sold or assigned a debt that Patient owed to the Hospital; and

        ii. The person is retained by Hospital to pursue litigation for debts owed by Patients.

REFERENCES

26 Code of Federal Regulations 1.501(r)-1 through 1.501(r)-7

California Consumer Credit Reporting Agencies Act

California Health and Safety Code sections 124700 through 127446

22 California Code of Regulations sections 96051 through 96051.37

Federal Independent Dispute Resolution Portal

Hospital Third Party Lien Policy

Internal Revenue Code section 501 (r)

Medical Foundation Charity Care and Low Income Uninsured Policy

Policy on Financial Assistance for Sutter Hospitals (Charity Care)

Policy for Initiation of Litigation or Arbitration Involving Third Party Payers

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment A: Notice of Assignment to Collection Agency

Attachment B: Notice of Rights

Attachment A

Notice of Assignment to Collection Agency

Patient Name:____

Date(s) of Services:_____

Patient Account Number:_

Date of Initial Bill:[1]__

Collection Agency:_

Amount Due:_____

Date Patient Received Financial Assistance Application (if applicable) __

Date of Completion for Application for Financial Assistance (if applicable)____

Date of Determination of Eligibility for Financial Assistance (if applicable):____

Health Coverage and Coverage Type (or N/A if patient is uninsured):___

Thank you for choosing Sutter Health. As of the date of this Notice of Assignment to Collection Agency, Sutter Health has not received payment of the amount due that is set forth above. This Notice of Assignment to Collection Agency is to notify you that the patient account identified above is being assignment to a collection agency. The collection agency is identified above. The collection agency may attempt to contact you in writing or by telephone concerning the amount that remains outstanding.

Itemized Bill. You can obtain an itemized bill regarding the amount owed. Please contact Patient Financial Services at 855-398-1633 if you would like to receive an itemized bill.

Financial Assistance. Sutter Health is committed to providing financial assistance to qualified low income patients, and to patients who have insurance that requires the patient to pay a significant portion of their care. The following is a summary of the eligibility requirements for Financial Assistance and the application process for patient who wish to seek Financial Assistance.

If you received hospital services in the **Emergency Department at Sutter Lakeside Hospital** or a **Sutter Health-affiliated Rural Health Clinic**, the following category of patients are eligible for Financial Assistance:

[1] The Initial Bill included a Notice of Rights that provided details about Sutter Health's Financial Assistance policy.

- Patients who have a family income at or below 400% of the federal poverty level are eligible for Financial Assistance.

If you received hospital services **at any other Sutter Health-affiliated hospital**, the following categories of patients are eligible for Financial Assistance:

- Patients who have no third-party source of payment, such as an insurance company or government program, for any portion of their medical expenses and have a family income at or below 400% of the federal poverty level.

- Patients who are covered by insurance but have (i) family income at or below 400% of the federal poverty level; **and** (ii) medical expenses for themselves or their family (incurred at the hospital affiliate or paid to other providers in the past 12 months) that exceed 10% of the patient's family income.

- Patients who are covered by insurance but exhaust their benefits either before or during their stay at the hospital, and have a family income at or below 400% of the federal poverty level.

Sutter Health's application for Financial Assistance is included with this Notice of Assignment to Collection Agency.

Hospital Bill Complaint Program. The Hospital Bill Complaint Program is a state program, which reviews hospital decisions about whether you qualify for help paying your hospital bill. If you believe you were wrongly denied financial assistance, you may file a complaint with the Hospital Bill Complaint Program. Go to HospitalBillComplaintProgram.hcai.ca.gov for more information and to file a complaint.

Contact Information: Patient Financial Services is available to answer questions you may have about your hospital bill or would like to apply for Financial Assistance or government program. The telephone number is 855-398-1633. Our telephone hours are 8:00 A.M. to 5:00 P.M., Monday through Friday.

ATTENTION: If you need help in your language, please call 855-398-1633 or visit the Patient Financial Services office. Our telephone hours are 8:00 A.M. to 5:00 P.M., Monday through Friday. Aids and services for people with disabilities, like documents in braille, large print, audio, and other accessible electronic formats are also available. These services are free.

ملحوظة: إذا احتجت إلى مُساعدة بلُغتك، يُرجى الاتصال بهاتف رقم 855-398-1633 أو تفضَّل بزيارة مكتب خدمات المرضى المالية بالمُستشفى. نتلقى المكالمات الهاتفيّة من الثامنة صباحًا حتى الخامسة مساءً من يوم الاثنين إلى يوم الجُمعة. كذلك نوفِّر دعم وخدمات للأشخاص ذوي الإعاقات، على سبيل المثال، مُستندات مطبوعة بحروف بارزة (برايل) أو بحروف كبيرة، أو مُستندات صوتيّة أو غيرها من الصيغ الإلكترونيّة الميسّرة. مع العلم بأن هذه الخدمات مجّانيّة.(Arabic)

ՈՒՇԱԴՐՈՒԹՅՈՒՆ. Եթե ձեր լեզվով օգնության կարիք ունեք, խնդրում ենք զանգահարել 855-398-1633 հեռախոսահամարով կամ այցելել հիվանդանոցում գտնվող Հիվանդների ֆինանսական ծառայությունների գրասենյակ: Մեր հեռախոսային ժամերն են՝ 8:00 A.M.-ից մինչև 5:00 P.M., երկուշաբթիից ուրբաթ: Հասանելի են նաև օժանդակ միջոցներ և ծառայություններ հաշմանդամություն ունեցող անձանց համար, օրինակ՝ փաստաթղթեր բրայլով, խոշոր տպագրությամբ, (Armenian)

កំណត់ចំណាំ៖ ប្រសិនបើលោកអ្នកត្រូវការជំនួយជាភាសារបស់លោកអ្នក សូមហៅទូរសព្ទទៅលេខ 855-398-1633 ឬមកកាន់ការិយាល័យសេវាកម្មហិរញ្ញវត្ថុសម្រាប់អ្នកជំងឺនៅមន្ទីរពេទ្យ។ ម៉ោងទទួលទូរសព្ទរបស់យើងគឺចាប់ពីម៉ោង 8:00 ព្រឹកដល់ម៉ោង 5:00 ល្ងាច ចាប់ពីថ្ងៃចន្ទដល់ថ្ងៃសុក្រ។ ជំនួយ និងសេវាកម្មសម្រាប់អ្នកដែលមានពិការភាព គឺមានដូចជាអក្សរស្ទាប ឯកសារបោះពុម្ពធំៗ សំឡេង ហើយទម្រង់អេឡិចត្រូនិកដែល អាចចូលប្រើបានផ្សេងទៀតក៏មានផ្តល់ជូនផងដែរ។ សេវាកម្មទាំងនេះគឺមិនគិតថ្លៃទេ។ (Cambodian/Khmer)

請注意：如果您需要語言方面的協助，請致電855-398-1633或前往醫院的病人財務服務辦公室。我們接聽電話的時間是星期一至五上午8:00至下午5:00。我們還為殘障人士提供輔助和服務，例如盲文、大字體、音訊和其他無障礙電子格式的文件。這些服務都是免費的。(Chinese Traditional)

توجه: اگر نیاز به کمک به زبان خود دارید، لطفاً با شماره 855-398-1633 تماس بگیرید یا به دفتر خدمات مالی بیماران (Patient Financial Services تماس بگیرید. ساعات تماس تلفنی ما 8:00 صبح تا 5:00 بعد از ظهر، روزهای دوشنبه تا جمعه است. کمک‌ها و خدمات برای افراد دارای معلولیت نیز در دسترس است ازجمله اسناد به خط بریل، چاپ درشت، صوتی و سایر فرمت‌های الکترونیکی. این خدمات رایگان هستند.(Farsi)

ध्यान दें: यदि आपको अपनी भाषा में सहायता की आवश्यकता है, तो कृपया 855-398-1633 पर कॉल करें या चिकित्सालय में रोगी वित्तीय सेवा कार्यालय में जाएँ। हमारा दूरभाष समय सोमवार से शुक्रवार, प्रातः 8:00 बजे से सायंकाल 5:00 बजे तक है। विकलांगता वाले लोगों के लिए सहायता और सेवाएँ, जैसे कि ब्रेल, बड़े प्रिंट, ऑडियो और अन्य अभिगम्य इलेक्ट्रॉनिक प्रारूप में प्रलेख भी उपलब्ध हैं। ये सेवाएँ निःशुल्क हैं। (Hindi)

LUS QHIA TSEEM CEEB: Yog tias koj xav tau kev pab ua koj hom lus, thov hu rau 855-398-1633 los sis mus ntsib lub chaw hauj lwm Muab Kev Pab Cuam Fab Nyiaj Txiag Rau Tus Neeg Mob ntawm lub tsev kho mob. Peb lub sij hawm txais xov tooj yog 8:00 teev sawv ntxov. mus txog 5:00 teev yuav tsaus ntuj, Hnub Monday txog Hnub Friday. Tsis tas li ntawd, kuj tseem muaj cov kev pab thiab cov kev pab cuam rau cov neeg xiam oob qhab, xws li cov ntaub ntawv ua cov ntawv su, cov ntawv luam loj, suab, thiab lwm hom ntaub ntawv es lev thos niv. Cov kev pab cuam no pub dawb xwb. (Hmong)

ご注意： ご自身の言語でのサポートが必要な場合は、855-398-1633 までお電話いただくか、病院の患者向けフィナンシャルサービスオフィスへお越しください。電話の受付時間は、月曜から金曜の午前8時～午後5時です 視覚障害者向けのサポートやサービス、例えば点字、大きな活字の印刷物、音声、その他の電子形式の文書もご用意しております。これらのサービスは無料でご利用いただけます (Japanese)

주의: 귀하가 사용하시는 언어로 도움이 필요하시면 전화(855-398-1633)를 하시거나 병원의 환자 재정부서를 방문하십시오. 저희의 전화 통화 가능 시간(월요일 – 금요일)은 오전 8시부터 오후 5시까지입니다. 장애인을 위한 보조 기구 및 서비스(점자 문서, 큰 활자, 오디오, 그리고 기타 접근 가능한 전자 형식 등)를 이용하실 수 있습니다. 이 서비스들은 무료입니다. (Korean)

ध्यान दें: यदि आपको अपनी भाषा में सहायता की आवश्यकता है, तो कृपया 855-398-1633 पर कॉल करें या चिकित्सालय में रोगी वित्तीय सेवा कार्यालय में जाएँ। हमारा दूरभाष समय सोमवार से शुक्रवार, प्रातः 8:00 बजे से सायंकाल 5:00 बजे तक है। विकलांगता वाले लोगों के लिए सहायता और सेवाएँ, जैसे कि ब्रेल, बड़े प्रिंट, ऑडियो और अन्य अभिगम्य इलेक्ट्रॉनिक प्रारूप में प्रलेख भी उपलब्ध हैं। ये सेवाएँ निःशुल्क हैं। (Punjabi)

ВНИМАНИЕ! Если вам нужна помощь на вашем языке, пожалуйста, позвоните по телефону 855-398-1633 или посетите отдел финансового обслуживания пациентов в больнице. Мы работаем по телефону с 8:00 пополуночи до 5:00 пополудни, с понедельника по пятницу. Также доступны вспомогательные средства и услуги для людей с ограниченными возможностями, например, документы шрифтом Брайля либо крупным шрифтом, в аудио- и иных электронных форматах, обеспечивающих доступную среду. Эти услуги предоставляются бесплатно! (Russian)

ATENCIÓN: Si necesita ayuda en su idioma, llame al 8553981633 o visite la oficina de Servicios Financieros para Pacientes en el hospital. Nuestro horario de atención telefónica es de lunes a viernes, de 8:00 a. m. a 5:00 p. m. También están disponibles ayudas y servicios para personas con discapacidades, como documentos en braille, letra grande, audio y otros formatos electrónicos accesibles. Estos servicios son gratis. (Spanish)

PAUNAWA: Kung kailangan mo ng tulong sa iyong wika, pakitawagan ang 855-398-1633 o bisitahin ang opisina ng Patient Financial Services ng ospital. Ang oras ng pagsagot namin sa telepono ay mula 8:00 A.M. hanggang 5:00 P.M., Lunes hanggang Biyernes. Available din ang mga tulong at serbisyo para sa mga taong may kapansanan, tulad ng mga dokumento na nasa braille, malalaking print, audio,

at iba pang electronic format na maaaring ma-access. Ang mga serbisyong ito ay libre. (Tagalog)

<u>โปรดทราบ</u>: หากคุณต้องการความช่วยเหลือในภาษาของคุณ โปรดติดต่อ 855-398-1633 หรือติดต่อสำนักบริการทางการเงินสำหรับผู้ป่วยที่โรงพยาบาล คุณสามารถติดต่อทางโทรศัพท์ได้ตั้งแต่วันจันทร์ถึงวันศุกร์ ระหว่างเวลา 8.00 น. ถึง 17.00 น.นอกจากนี้ยังมีบริการและความช่วยเหลือสำหรับผู้พิการ เช่น เอกสารในอักษรเบรลล์ ตัวอักษรขนาดใหญ่ บันทึกเสียง และเอกสารที่เข้าถึงได้รูปแบบอิเล็กทรอนิกส์อื่น ๆ ซึ่งจะจัดหาให้โดยไม่คิดค่าใช้จ่าย (Thai)

<u>LƯU Ý</u>: Nếu quý vị cần được trợ giúp bằng ngôn ngữ của mình, vui lòng gọi tới số 855-398-1633 hoặc đến văn phòng Dịch Vụ Tài Chính dành cho Bệnh Nhân tại bệnh viện. Giờ nhận điện thoại của chúng tôi là từ 8 giờ sáng đến 5 giờ chiều, từ Thứ Hai đến Thứ Sáu. Cũng có các hỗ trợ và dịch vụ dành cho người khuyết tật như tài liệu bằng chữ nổi, chữ in lớn, dạng âm thanh và các định dạng điện tử dễ tiếp cận khác. Những dịch vụ này đều miễn phí. (Vietnamese)

Attachment B

Notice of Rights

Thank you for selecting Sutter Health for your recent services. Enclosed please find a statement of the charges for your hospital visit. **Payment is due immediately**. You may be entitled to discounts if you meet certain financial qualifications, discussed below.

Please be aware that this is the bill for hospital services only. There may be additional charges for services that will be provided by physicians during your stay in the hospital, such as bills from physicians, and any anesthesiologists, pathologists, radiologists, ambulance services, or other medical professionals who are not employees of the hospital. You may receive a separate bill for their services.

Summary of Your Rights: State and federal law require debt collectors to treat you fairly and prohibit debt collectors from making false statements or threats of violence, using obscene or profane language, or making improper communications with third parties, including your employer. Except under unusual circumstances, debt collectors may not contact you before 8:00 a.m. or after 9:00 p.m. In general, a debt collector may not give information about your debt to another person, other than your attorney or spouse. A debt collector may contact another person to confirm your location or to enforce a judgment. For more information about debt collection activities, you may contact the Federal Trade Commission by telephone at 1-877-FTC-HELP (382-4357) or online at www.ftc.gov.

Nonprofit credit counseling services, as well as consumer assistance from local legal services offices, may be available in your area. Please contact Patient Financial Services office at 855-398-1633 for a referral.

Sutter Health has agreements with external collection agencies to collect payments from patients. Collection Agencies are required to comply with the hospital's policies. Collection Agencies are also required to recognize and adhere to any payments plans agreed upon by the hospital and the patient.

No Reporting to Consumer Credit Reporting Agency. A holder of this medical debt contract is prohibited by Section 1785.27 of the Civil Code from furnishing any information related to this debt to a consumer credit reporting agency. In addition to any other penalties allowed by law, if a person knowingly violates this section by furnishing information regarding this debt to a consumer credit reporting agency, the debt shall be void and unenforceable.

Financial Assistance (Charity Care): Sutter Health is committed to providing financial assistance to qualified low-income patients, and to patients who have insurance that requires the patient to pay a significant portion of their care. The

following is a summary of the eligibility requirements for Financial Assistance and the application process for a patient who wishes to seek Financial Assistance.

If you received hospital services in the **Emergency Department at Sutter Lakeside Hospital** or a **Sutter Health-affiliated Rural Health Clinic**, the following category of patients are eligible for Financial Assistance:

- Patients who have a family income at or below 400% of the federal poverty level are eligible for Financial Assistance.

If you received hospital services **at any other Sutter Health-affiliated hospital**, the following categories of patients are eligible for Financial Assistance:

- Patients who have no third-party source of payment, such as an insurance company or government program, for any portion of their medical expenses **and** have a family income at or below 400% of the federal poverty level.

- Patients who are covered by insurance but have (i) family income at or below 400% of the federal poverty level; **and** (ii) medical expenses for themselves or their family (incurred at the hospital affiliate or paid to other providers in the past 12 months) that exceed 10% of the patient's family income.

- Patients who are covered by insurance but exhaust their benefits either before or during their stay at the hospital and have a family income at or below 400% of the federal poverty level.

You may apply for Financial Assistance using the application form that is available from Patient Financial Services, which is located at located within the Patient Access/Registration Departments at the Hospital, or by calling Patient Financial Services at 855-398-1633, or on the Sutter Health or Hospital website (www.sutterhealth.org). You may also submit an application by speaking with a representative from Patient Financial Services, who will assist you with completing the application. During the application process you will be asked to provide information regarding the number of people in your family, your monthly income, and other information that will assist the Hospital with determining your eligibility for Financial Assistance. You may be asked to provide a pay stub or tax records to assist Sutter with verifying your income.

After you submit the application, the Hospital will review the information and notify you in writing regarding your eligibility. If you have any questions during the application process, you may contact the Patient Financial Services office at (855) 398-1633.

If you disagree with the Hospital's decision, you may submit a dispute to the Patient Financial Services office.

Copies of this Hospital's Financial Assistance Policy, the Plain Language Summary and Application, as well as government program applications are available in

multiple languages in person at our Patient Registration or Patient Financial Services offices, as well as at sutterhealth.org and available by mail. We can also send you a copy of the Financial Assistance Policy free of charge if you contact our Patient Financial Services office at 855-398-1633.

In accordance with Internal Revenue Code Section 1.501(r)-5, Sutter Health adopts the prospective Medicare method for amounts generally billed; however, patients who are eligible for financial assistance are not financially responsible for more than the amounts generally billed because eligible patients do not pay any amount.

Pending applications: If an application has been submitted for another health coverage program at the same time that you submit an application for charity care, neither application shall preclude eligibility for the other program.

Health Insurance/Government Program Coverage/Financial Assistance: If you have health insurance coverage, Medicare, Medi-Cal/Medicaid, California Children's Services, or any other source of payment for this bill, please contact Patient Financial Services at 855-398-1633. If appropriate, Patient Financial Services will bill those entities for your care.

If you do not have health insurance or coverage through a government program like Medi- Cal/Medicaid or Medicare, you may be eligible for government program assistance. Medi-Cal's presumptive eligibility program provides qualified individuals immediate access to temporary, no-cost Medi-Cal while applying for permanent Medi-Cal coverage or other health coverage. Patient Financial Services can provide you with application forms and assist you with the application process.

If you have received an award of Financial Assistance from the Hospital that you believe covers the services that are the subject of this bill, please contact Patient Financial Services at 855-398-1633.

California Health Benefit Exchange: You may be eligible for health care coverage under Covered California. Contact Patient Financial Services for more detail and assistance to see if you quality for health care coverage through Covered California.

Hospital Bill Complaint Program: The Hospital Bill Complaint Program is a state program, which reviews Hospital decisions about whether you qualify for help paying your hospital bill. If you believe you were wrongly denied financial assistance, you may file a complaint with the Hospital Bill Complaint Program. Go to HospitalBillComplaintProgram.hcai.ca.gov for more information and to file a complaint.

Help Paying Your Bill. There are free consumer advocacy organizations that will help you understand the billing and payment process. You may call the Health Consumer Alliance at 888-804-3536 or go to https://healthconsumer.org for more information. Please contact Patient Financial Services for further information.

Price Transparency. Healthcare cost transparency is important to help consumers make informed decisions about their care. Sutter Health post a list of standard charges for more than 300 services provided in Sutter hospitals. Please visit the following website for more information: https://myhealthonline.sutterhealth.org/mho/GuestEstimates.

Contact Information: Patient Financial Services is available to answer questions you may have about your Hospital bill or to assist with applying for Financial Assistance or a government program. The telephone number is 855-398-1633. Our telephone hours are 8:00 A.M. to 5:00 P.M., Monday through Friday.

ATTENTION: If you need help in your language, please call 855-398-1633 or visit the Patient Financial Services office at the hospital. Our telephone hours are 8:00 A.M. to 5:00 P.M., Monday through Friday. Aids and services for people with disabilities, like documents in braille, large print, audio, and other accessible electronic formats are also available. These services are free.

ملحوظة: إذا احتجت إلى مُساعدة بلُغتك، يُرجى الاتصال بهاتف رقم 855-398-1633 أو تفضَّل بزيارة مكتب خدمات المرضى المالية بالمُستشفى. نتلقى المكالمات الهاتفيّة من الثامنة صباحًا حتى الخامسة مساءً من يوم الاثنين إلى يوم الجُمعة. كذلك نوفِّر دعم وخدمات للأشخاص ذوي الإعاقات، على سبيل المثال، مُستندات مطبوعة بحروف بارزة (برايل) أو بحروف كبيرة، أو مُستندات صوتيّة أو غيرها من الصيغ الإلكترونيّة الميسّرة. مع العلم بأن هذه الخدمات مجّانيّة.(Arabic)

ՈՒՇԱԴՐՈՒԹՅՈՒՆ. Եթե ձեր լեզվով օգնության կարիք ունեք, խնդրում ենք զանգահարել 855-398-1633 հեռախոսահամարով կամ այցելել հիվանդանոցում գտնվող Հիվանդների ֆինանսական ծառայությունների գրասենյակ: Մեր հեռախոսային ժամերն են՝ 8:00 A.M.-ից մինչև 5:00 P.M., երկուշաբթիից ուրբաթ: Հասանելի են նաև օժանդակ միջոցներ և ծառայություններ հաշմանդամություն ունեցող անձանց համար, օրինակ՝ փաստաթղթեր բրայլով, խոշոր տպագրությամբ, (Armenian)

កំណត់ចំណាំ៖ ប្រសិនបើលោកអ្នកត្រូវការជំនួយជាភាសារបស់លោកអ្នក សូមហៅទូរសព្ទទៅលេខ 855-398-1633 ឬមកកាន់ការិយាល័យសេវាកម្មហិរញ្ញវត្ថុសម្រាប់អ្នកជំងឺនៅមន្ទីរពេទ្យ។ ម៉ោងទទួលទូរសព្ទរបស់យើងគឺចាប់ពីម៉ោង 8:00 ព្រឹកដល់ម៉ោង 5:00 ល្ងាច ចាប់ពីថ្ងៃចន្ទដល់ថ្ងៃសុក្រ។ ជំនួយ និងសេវាកម្មសម្រាប់អ្នកដែលមានពិការភាព គឺមានដូចជាអក្សរស្ទាប ឯកសារបោះពុម្ពធំៗ សំឡេង ហើយទម្រង់អេឡិចត្រូនិកដែលអាចចូលប្រើបានផ្សេងទៀតក៏មានផ្តល់ជូនផងដែរ។ សេវាកម្មទាំងនេះគឺមិនគិតថ្លៃទេ។ (Cambodian/Khmer)

請注意：如果您需要語言方面的協助，請致電855-398-1633或前往醫院的病人財務服務辦公室。我們接聽電話的時間是星期一至五上午8:00至下午5:00。我們還為殘障人士提供輔助和服務，例如盲文、大字體、音訊和其他無障礙電子格式的文件。這些服務都是免費的。(Chinese Traditional)

توجه: اگر نیاز به کمک به زبان خود دارید، لطفاً با شماره 1633-398-855 تماس بگیرید یا به دفتر خدمات مالی بیماران (Patient Financial Services) در بیمارستان تماس بگیرید. ساعات تماس تلفنی ما 8:00 صبح تا 5:00 بعد از ظهر، روزهای دوشنبه تا جمعه است. کمک‌ها و خدمات برای افراد دارای معلولیت نیز در دسترس است ازجمله اسناد به خط بریل، چاپ درشت، صوتی و سایر فرمت‌های الکترونیکی. این خدمات رایگان هستند.(Farsi)

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LUS QHIA TSEEM CEEB: Yog tias koj xav tau kev pab ua koj hom lus, thov hu rau 855-398-1633 los sis mus ntsib lub chaw hauj lwm Muab Kev Pab Cuam Fab Nyiaj Txiag Rau Tus Neeg Mob ntawm lub tsev kho mob. Peb lub sij hawm txais xov tooj yog 8:00 teev saww ntxov. mus txog 5:00 teev yuav tsaus ntuj, Hnub Monday txog Hnub Friday. Tsis tas li ntawd, kuj tseem muaj cov kev pab thiab cov kev pab cuam rau cov neeg xiam oob qhab, xws li cov ntaub ntawv ua cov ntawv su, cov ntawv luam loj, suab, thiab lwm hom ntaub ntawv es lev thos niv. Cov kev pab cuam no pub dawb xwb. (Hmong)

ご注意： ご自身の言語でのサポートが必要な場合は、855-398-1633 までお電話いただくか、病院の患者向けフィナンシャルサービスオフィスへお越しください。電話の受付時間は、月曜から金曜の午前8時～午後5時です 視覚障害者向けのサポートやサービス、例えば点字、大きな活字の印刷物、音声、その他の電子形式の文書もご用意しております。これらのサービスは無料でご利用いただけます (Japanese)

주의: 귀하가 사용하시는 언어로 도움이 필요하시면 전화(855-398-1633)를 하시거나 병원의 환자 재정부서를 방문하십시오. 저희의 전화 통화 가능 시간(월요일 – 금요일)은 오전 8시부터 오후 5시까지입니다. 장애인을 위한 보조 기구 및 서비스(점자 문서, 큰 활자, 오디오, 그리고 기타 접근 가능한 전자 형식 등)를 이용하실 수 있습니다. 이 서비스들은 무료입니다. (Korean)

ध्यान दें: यदि आपको अपनी भाषा में सहायता की आवश्यकता है, तो कृपया 855-398-1633 पर कॉल करें या चिकित्सालय में रोगी वित्तीय सेवा कार्यालय में जाएँ। हमारा दूरभाष समय सोमवार से शुक्रवार, प्रातः 8:00 बजे से सायंकाल 5:00 बजे तक है। विकलांगता वाले लोगों के लिए सहायता और सेवाएँ, जैसे कि ब्रेल, बड़े प्रिंट, ऑडियो और अन्य अभिगम्य इलेक्ट्रॉनिक प्रारूप में प्रलेख भी उपलब्ध हैं। ये सेवाएँ निःशुल्क हैं। (Punjabi)

ВНИМАНИЕ! Если вам нужна помощь на вашем языке, пожалуйста, позвоните по телефону 855-398-1633 или посетите отдел финансового обслуживания пациентов в больнице. Мы работаем по телефону с 8:00 пополуночи до 5:00 пополудни, с понедельника по пятницу. Также доступны вспомогательные средства и услуги для людей с ограниченными возможностями, например, документы шрифтом Брайля либо крупным шрифтом, в аудио- и иных электронных форматах, обеспечивающих доступную среду. Эти услуги предоставляются бесплатно! (Russian)

ATENCIÓN: Si necesita ayuda en su idioma, llame al 8553981633 o visite la oficina de Servicios Financieros para Pacientes en el hospital. Nuestro horario de atención telefónica es de lunes a viernes, de 8:00 a. m. a 5:00 p. m. También están disponibles ayudas y servicios para personas con discapacidades, como documentos en braille, letra grande, audio y otros formatos electrónicos accesibles. Estos servicios son gratis. (Spanish)

PAUNAWA: Kung kailangan mo ng tulong sa iyong wika, pakitawagan ang 855-398-1633 o bisitahin ang opisina ng Patient Financial Services ng ospital. Ang oras ng pagsagot namin sa telepono ay mula 8:00 A.M. hanggang 5:00 P.M., Lunes hanggang Biyernes. Available din ang mga tulong at serbisyo para sa mga taong may kapansanan, tulad ng mga dokumento na nasa braille, malalaking print, audio, at iba pang electronic format na maaaring ma-access. Ang mga serbisyong ito ay libre. (Tagalog)

โปรดทราบ: หากคุณต้องการความช่วยเหลือในภาษาของคุณ โปรดติดต่อ 855-398-1633 หรือติดต่อสำนักบริการทางการเงินสำหรับผู้ป่วยที่โรงพยาบาล คุณสามารถติดต่อทางโทรศัพท์ได้ตั้งแต่วันจันทร์ถึงวันศุกร์ ระหว่างเวลา 8.00 น. ถึง 17.00 น.นอกจากนี้ยังมีบริการและความช่วยเหลือสำหรับผู้พิการ เช่น เอกสารในอักษรเบรลล์ ตัวอักษรขนาดใหญ่ บันทึกเสียง และเอกสารที่เข้าถึงได้รูปแบบอิเล็กทรอนิกส์อื่น ๆ ซึ่งจะจัดหาให้โดยไม่คิดค่าใช้จ่าย (Thai)

LƯU Ý: Nếu quý vị cần được trợ giúp bằng ngôn ngữ của mình, vui lòng gọi tới số 855-398-1633 hoặc đến văn phòng Dịch Vụ Tài Chính dành cho Bệnh Nhân tại bệnh viện. Giờ nhận điện thoại của chúng tôi là từ 8 giờ sáng đến 5 giờ chiều, từ Thứ Hai đến Thứ Sáu. Cũng có các hỗ trợ và dịch vụ dành cho người khuyết tật như tài liệu bằng chữ nổi, chữ in lớn, dạng âm thanh và các định dạng điện tử dễ tiếp cận khác. Những dịch vụ này đều miễn phí. (Vietnamese)